

Word family: **speed / speeds / sped / speeded / speeding / speedy / speedily / speediness**

Base word: speed

Past tense / past participle: **sped** or **speeded**

ing form: speeding

Plural noun: speeds

Related forms:

* **speedy** (adj.) — 快速的；迅速完成的

* **speedily** (adv.) — 快速地；迅速地

* **speediness** (n.) — 迅速；快速

* **speeding** (n.) — 超速駕駛

* **speedometer** (n.) — 速度計；車速表

* **speed limit** — 速度限制；車速上限

* **speed bump** — 減速壘 / 減速帶

* **speed camera** — 測速攝影機

* **high-speed** — 高速的

* **low-speed** — 低速的

* **top speed** — 最高速度

* **full speed** — 全速

* **at speed** — 以高速；在行進速度下

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Meaning in this passage

> Sometimes talking to him is like trying to keep up with a tiny scientist, because his mind moves at lightning **speed**.

Here, **speed** means:

the rate at which something moves, happens, or operates — 速度；速率

In **lightning speed**, the phrase means **extremely high speed**.

中文翻譯：

有時候跟他交談，就像要努力跟上一位小小科學家的思路一樣，因為他的腦袋**轉得飛快**。

Here:

speed = 速度；某件事移動、進行或發生的快慢程度

1. **speed** (移動速度) — 速度 ; 速率

This is the core meaning and the one used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> His mind moves at lightning **speed**.

他的腦袋以**極快的速度**運轉。

Practice 2

> The car was travelling at a high **speed**.

那輛車正以很高的**速度**行駛。

Practice 3

> The train gradually increased its **speed**.

火車逐漸提高了**速度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

speed = 某人或某物移動的快慢程度

2. **speed** (事情發生或完成的快慢) — 速度 ; 進展速度

Speed can refer to how quickly a process happens, even when there is no physical movement.

Practice 1

> I was surprised by the **speed** of his recovery.

我對他康復的**速度**感到驚訝。

Practice 2

> Technology is changing at an incredible **speed**.

科技正以驚人的**速度**改變。

MCQ-ready definition:

****speed = 某個過程、變化或事情發生的快慢程度****

3. ****speed (工作 / 反應的迅速程度) — 迅速 ; 效率上的速度****

This often emphasizes ****quickness of performance****.

Practice 1

> She completed the task with impressive ****speed****.

她以令人印象深刻的****速度****完成了工作。

Practice 2

> The emergency team responded with great ****speed****.

緊急應變隊伍非常****迅速地****作出反應。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****speed = 做事或作出反應時的迅速程度****

4. ****at speed — 以高速 ; 快速行進中****

Practice 1

> The cyclist took the corner ****at speed****.

那名單車手****高速****轉彎。

Practice 2

> The vehicle hit the barrier ****at speed****.

那輛車在****高速行駛時****撞上護欄。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****at speed = 以相當快的速度移動****

5. ****at high/low speed — 以高速 / 低速****

Practice 1

> The machine can operate safely at **high speed**.

這部機器可以安全地**高速運作**。

Practice 2

> Drive at **low speed** on icy roads.

在結冰的路面上應以**低速**駕駛。

MCQ-ready definition:

at high/low speed = 以較高 / 較低的速度運作或移動

6. **top speed — 最高速度**

Practice 1

> The car can reach a **top speed** of 250 kilometres per hour.

這輛車的**最高速度**可達每小時 250 公里。

Practice 2

> The animal can run at **top speed** for only a short distance.

那種動物只能在短距離內以**最高速度**奔跑。

MCQ-ready definition:

top speed = 某人、車輛或機器能達到的最高速度

7. **full speed — 全速**

Practice 1

> The boat moved ahead at **full speed**.

那艘船**全速**前進。

Practice 2

> He ran towards the station at **full speed**.

他以**全速**跑向車站。

MCQ-ready definition:

full speed = 以能達到的最快速度

8. **pick up speed** — 加速；速度增加

A highly useful expression.

Practice 1

> The train began to **pick up speed** after leaving the station.

火車離站後開始**加速**。

Practice 2

> The project is finally **picking up speed**.

這個項目終於開始**加快進度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pick up speed = 速度增加；進展開始加快

This can be literal or figurative.

9. **lose speed** — 減速；速度下降

Practice 1

> The car began to **lose speed** on the steep hill.

那輛車在陡坡上開始**減速**。

Practice 2

> The boat suddenly **lost speed**.

那艘船突然**慢了下來**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****lose speed = 速度降低****

10. ****gather speed — 逐漸加速****

Practice 1

> The train ****gathered speed**** as it left the city.

火車離開城市後逐漸****加速****。

Practice 2

> The campaign is ****gathering speed****.

這項活動正逐步****加快進展****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gather speed = 逐漸加快速度或進展****

11. ****speed up (verb) — 加速；使加快****

This is one of the most important verbal uses.

Practice 1

> The driver ****sped up**** to overtake the truck.

司機****加速****超越貨車。

Practice 2

> We need to ****speed up**** the approval process.

我們需要****加快****審批程序。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****speed up = 使某人 / 某物移動、運作或進行得更快****

12. ****speed something up — 加快某事****

Practice 1

> The new software should **speed up the process**.

新軟件應該可以**加快流程**。

Practice 2

> Extra staff were brought in to **speed things up**.

公司調來額外人手，以**加快進度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

speed something up = 令某件事更快完成或進行

13. **speed along / speed down / speed through — 快速行駛；疾馳**

The verb **speed** can itself mean **move very quickly**.

Practice 1

> A motorbike **sped past us**.

一輛電單車從我們身旁**疾馳而過**。

Practice 2

> The ambulance **sped through the streets**.

救護車在街道上**高速駛過**。

MCQ-ready definition:

speed = 快速移動或高速行駛

14. **speed past someone/something — 飛快經過**

Practice 1

> The car **sped past** the school.

那輛車**高速駛過**學校。

Practice 2

> A cyclist **sped past me** on the path.

一名單車手在小徑上**飛快地從我身旁經過**。

MCQ-ready definition:

speed past = 以很快速度從某人 / 某物旁邊經過

15. **speed off / speed away** — 飛快離去

Practice 1

> The car **sped away** before anyone could see the number plate.

那輛車在人們看清車牌之前便**飛快駛走**了。

Practice 2

> The motorcyclist **sped off** down the road.

那名電單車手沿着馬路**疾馳離去**。

MCQ-ready definition:

speed away/off = 以很快速度離開

16. **speeding** — 超速駕駛

Here **speeding** is a lexicalized noun referring to driving faster than legally allowed.

Practice 1

> He was fined for **speeding**.

他因**超速駕駛**而被罰款。

Practice 2

> **Speeding** is one of the main causes of serious road accidents.

超速駕駛是嚴重交通意外的主要成因之一。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****speeding = 駕駛速度超過法定限制****

17. ****speed limit — 速度限制；車速上限****

Practice 1

> The ****speed limit**** here is 50 kilometres per hour.

這裏的****車速上限****是每小時 50 公里。

Practice 2

> Drivers must obey the ****speed limit****.

駕駛者必須遵守****速度限制****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****speed limit = 法例規定車輛可行駛的最高速度****

18. ****speed camera — 測速攝影機****

Practice 1

> A ****speed camera**** recorded the car travelling too fast.

一部****測速攝影機****拍到那輛車超速行駛。

Practice 2

> There are several ****speed cameras**** on this road.

這條路上有幾部****測速攝影機****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****speed camera = 用來偵測和記錄超速車輛的攝影裝置****

19. ****speed bump — 減速壘；減速帶****

Practice 1

> Drivers have to slow down for the **speed bump**.

駕駛者遇到**減速壘**時必須減速。

Practice 2

> The council installed several **speed bumps** near the school.

當局在學校附近設置了幾個**減速壘**。

MCQ-ready definition:

speed bump = 設在路面上迫使車輛減速的凸起物

20. **high-speed** — 高速的

A common compound adjective.

Practice 1

> We travelled by **high-speed train**.

我們乘搭**高速列車**。

Practice 2

> The office has **high-speed internet**.

辦公室有**高速網絡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

high-speed = 以高速運作、移動或傳輸的

21. **speedy** — 快速的；迅速完成的

Speedy generally describes something completed or happening quickly.

Practice 1

> We wish you a **speedy recovery**.

祝你**早日康復**。

Practice 2

> The problem requires a **speedy solution**.

這個問題需要一個**迅速的解決方法**。

MCQ-ready definition:

speedy = 發生或完成得很快的

Important collocation

a speedy recovery is especially common:

早日康復 / 迅速康復

22. **with all speed / with great speed — 盡快；迅速地**

With all speed is somewhat formal.

Practice 1

> The documents must be sent **with all speed**.

這些文件必須**盡快**送出。

Practice 2

> The rescue team acted **with great speed**.

救援隊伍**迅速地**採取行動。

MCQ-ready definition:

with all/great speed = 非常迅速地；盡快地

23. **up to speed — 掌握最新情況；達到所需程度**

This is a very useful figurative idiom.

Practice 1

> It took me a few days to get **up to speed** with the new system.

我花了幾天才**熟悉 / 掌握**新系統。

Practice 2

> Can you bring me **up to speed** on the project?

你可以讓我**了解**這個項目的最新情況嗎？

MCQ-ready definition:

up to speed = 已掌握必要知識、最新情況或達到應有水平

Two common patterns

* **get up to speed** = 自己熟悉情況

* **bring someone up to speed** = 讓某人了解最新情況

24. **speed read / speed-reading** — 快速閱讀；速讀

Practice 1

> She learned how to **speed-read** academic articles.

她學會如何**快速閱讀**學術文章。

Practice 2

> **Speed-reading** can help when you need to scan a large amount of material.

需要瀏覽大量資料時，**速讀**可能有幫助。

MCQ-ready definition:

speed-read / speed-reading = 用比一般更快的速度閱讀，通常着重迅速掌握主要內容

Important distinction 1: **speed vs pace**

They overlap but are not identical.

speed

Often means measurable or objective **rate of movement or operation**.

> the **speed** of the car
> 車的**速度**

pace

Often means the **rate at which an activity develops or proceeds**.

> the **pace** of change
> 變化的**步伐 / 速度**

A useful contrast:

* **high speed** → very natural for vehicles/machines
* **fast pace** → very natural for life, work, change, activity

Important distinction 2: **speed vs velocity**

In everyday English, **speed** is the ordinary word.

In physics:

* **speed** = magnitude of motion
* **velocity** = speed **with direction**

So **velocity** is more technical.

Important distinction 3: **speed vs rate**

Speed often concerns **how fast** something moves or happens.

Rate is broader and can describe many measurable relationships:

* birth rate
* interest rate
* heart rate
* growth rate

You can say:

> the **speed** of change

and:

> the **rate** of change

but **rate** is generally more abstract and mathematical.

Important distinction 4: **speed** vs **quickness**

Speed is much more common for objective movement or processes.

Quickness usually refers more to the quality of being quick, especially reactions or actions.

> the **speed** of the train

> 火車的速度

> the **quickness** of her response

> 她反應之快

Important distinction 5: **speedy** vs **fast**

fast

Very broad and common.

> a **fast** car

> 一輛快車

speedy

Usually means **done or happening quickly**, rather than physically moving fast.

> a **speedy recovery**

> 迅速康復

> a **speedy decision**

> 迅速作出的決定

We normally say:

> a **fast car**

rather than:

> ? a **speedy car**

Important distinction 6: **sped** vs **speeded**

Both are correct past forms of **speed**.

sped

Most common when **speed** means move quickly.

> The car **sped away**.

那輛車飛快駛走。

speeded

Often appears especially when something is **made faster**, though **sped up** is also very common.

> The new system **speeded up** production.

新系統加快了生產。

> The new system **sped up** production.

Also correct.

So learners will see both.

Important distinction 7: **speed up** vs **hurry up**

speed up

increase the speed/rate of an action or process

> We need to **speed up** production.

我們需要加快生產。

hurry up

do something more quickly, usually because time is limited

> **Hurry up**, or we'll miss the bus.

快點，不然我們會錯過巴士。

Important distinction 8: **speed up** vs **accelerate**

Both can mean **加速**.

speed up

ordinary everyday English

accelerate

more formal/technical, and also commonly figurative

> The car **accelerated**.

汽車加速。

> Economic growth **accelerated**.

經濟增長加快。

Family-extension note

Speed has a clear semantic core:

how fast something moves, happens, develops, or operates

From that core, we get several useful branches:

- * physical movement

- * rate of a process

- * quick action or response

- * the verb **speed** = move quickly

- * **speed up** = make faster

- * road/traffic vocabulary such as **speeding**, **speed limit**, and **speed camera**

- * figurative expressions such as **up to speed**

The manual's conservative-splitting principle is especially useful here: **physical speed**, **speed of change**, and **speed of response** are contextually different, but they still share the same fundamental concept of **快慢程度**, so they should not be treated as completely unrelated lexical meanings.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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speed	速度；速率	how fast something moves	
speed of change/recovery	變化 / 康復速度	rate of a process	
with speed	迅速地	quick action	
at speed	高速行進中	moving quickly	
high/low speed	高 / 低速	level of speed	
top speed	最高速度	maximum	
full speed	全速	fastest possible	
pick up speed	加速；進展加快	become faster	
lose speed	減速	become slower	
gather speed	逐漸加速	increasingly fast	
speed up	加速；加快	increase speed	
speed something up	加快某事	make a process faster	
speed past	高速駛過	move quickly past	
speed away/off	飛快離去	leave quickly	
speeding	超速駕駛	exceed legal road speed	
speed limit	車速上限	legal maximum	
speed camera	測速攝影機	detects speeding	
speed bump	減速壟 / 減速帶	forces vehicles to slow	
high-speed	高速的	operating quickly	
speedy	迅速的	completed quickly	
speedy recovery	早日 / 迅速康復	common collocation	
up to speed	掌握最新情況 / 達到要求	figurative readiness	
bring someone up to speed	讓某人了解最新情況	update someone	
speed-read	速讀	read rapidly	

For your original sentence

> Sometimes talking to him is like trying to keep up with a tiny scientist, because his mind moves at lightning **speed**.

Here:

speed = 速度；快慢程度

and:

at lightning speed = 以極快的速度；快如閃電般

The expression refers to the **rate at which Leo's thoughts move**.

So this is figurative, but the word **speed** itself is still using its central meaning:

the rate at which something happens or moves

A natural Traditional Chinese translation is:

>因為他的腦袋**轉得飛快**。

or more literally:

>因為他的思考以**閃電般的速度**進行。